

Edward J. Penna

Desktop Support / IT Support

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SUMMARY

Recent SUNY Albany cybersecurity graduate with hands-on experience supporting end users, troubleshooting hardware and software issues, and working with ticket-based support. Backs that experience with a hands-on homelab portfolio spanning Windows/Active Directory administration, Linux, Docker, monitoring, backup/DR, and security operations — all documented as reproducible runbooks on GitHub. Strong at resolving login and system-access issues, diagnosing desktop problems, and communicating clearly with non-technical users.

EXPERIENCE

IT Support Volunteer — Stony Brook Hospital

06/2023 – 08/2023

- Provided technical support to end users by resolving login, system access, hardware, and software issues in a healthcare environment.
- Worked with tickets to track issues and support technical resolution follow-up.
- Diagnosed and troubleshoot basic desktop and user-side technical problems while communicating clearly with non-technical staff.
- Assisted users with day-to-day technical issues while maintaining a responsive, customer-focused support approach.

Summer Consultant — Broadridge

05/2024 – 08/2024

- Reviewed user access controls and supporting documentation to ensure accuracy, compliance, and proper system access.
- Worked with attention to detail on documentation and process validation in a professional team setting.
- Assisted with audit preparation, risk analysis, and process improvement in a structured enterprise environment.

Sales Associate — Lowe's

05/2022 – 08/2022

- Assisted customers directly while balancing accuracy, speed, and attention to detail.
- Used Zebra devices for inventory checks, item lookup, restocking workflows, and organized task execution.
- Helped maintain accurate item placement and product availability by locating items and verifying shelf organization.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Support & Systems	Windows troubleshooting, help-desk / end-user support, hardware & software diagnosis, ticket-based support, system configuration, technical documentation
OS & Infrastructure	Ubuntu / Linux Server administration, virtual machines (VMware, VirtualBox), Docker & Docker Compose, Nginx reverse proxy / TLS, systemd services & timers

Networking & Security	TCP/IP, network troubleshooting, SSH & secure remote access, Active Directory (lab), Linux hardening, SIEM (Wazuh), vulnerability scanning (Nessus)
Scripting & Tools	PowerShell, Bash, Python, Git & GitHub, Prometheus & Grafana, restic (backup / DR), Tailscale

PROJECTS

IT & Security Homelab Portfolio

github.com/wardoep

A growing set of hands-on IT, sysadmin, and SOC labs, each built and documented as a reproducible runbook with its configuration in version control.

- **Active Directory / Windows network lab:** stood up a Windows Server domain (corp.lab), joined a client workstation, created and managed domain user accounts, and worked through logged break/fix troubleshooting drills.
- **Docker self-hosted stack:** deployed multi-service Docker Compose environments on Ubuntu Server (Portainer, Nginx Proxy Manager with TLS, Uptime Kuma) behind a reverse proxy, with scripted named-volume backups.
- **Monitoring & observability:** Prometheus, Grafana (dashboards-as-code), and Alertmanager with node_exporter metrics, PromQL alert rules, and alert routing.
- **Windows/AD administration toolkit:** authored PowerShell scripts for system inventory, event-log triage, health reporting, and user on/off-boarding.
- **Backup & disaster recovery:** 3-2-1 backups with restic, automated on a systemd schedule with retention policies and tested restore drills.
- **Security operations:** Wazuh SIEM with custom detection rules, a Nessus vulnerability-management workflow, a Cowrie SSH honeypot with a Python log analyzer, phishing triage with a Python IOC extractor, and CIS-based Linux hardening measured with Lynis.

AI Infrastructure & Automation

- Deployed and maintained self-hosted automation tools on a Linux VPS, including setup, configuration, and ongoing troubleshooting of bot, connectivity, and network issues to keep services running reliably.
- Used Tailscale for secure remote access and private networking to hosted services.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

B.S. Cybersecurity — University at Albany, SUNY

09/2021 – 05/2025

CompTIA Network+ — in progress